While studying the *Baburnama*, I observed an interesting point. Babur has not chronicled his life for around eleven years, and one needs to rely upon other sources to juxtapose a case for continuity in the biography. I have explained about this gap in the next section.

But this gap has also allowed me to bring a halt to the tale of the pioneer of the second Tīmūrid colonization. The tale of Babur post-Humayun's birth and the latter's life will be addressed in the next volume of this series. The next volume would show us a drastically different Babur. It would capture all the realities of his attempt to wage jihad against the *Kafirs* of Hindustan and detailed account of the loot.

Author's Note on Absence of Records Between AD 1508 to AD 1519

A careful reading of the *Baburnama* and Gulbadan's *Humāyūnnāma*[*] shows that Babur was compiling the chronicles of AD 1509 not long before his illness and consequent death. It is evident that the records between AD 1509 and AD 1519 are completely missing, or one can say that there is a broken thread in his autobiography. Annette Susannah Beveridge writes, 'there is a lacuna of narrative extending over nearly eleven years'.

William Erskine has spoken about this period in his book, *History of India* while penning part of Babur's biography. But he ignores to use other firsthand sources like *Habību's-siyar* and *Tārīkh-i-rashīdī*. Abel Pavet de Courteille did translate the *Baburnama* from the Chagatai text, but he too does not cover this unchronicled patch. Most of the academicians who have tried to dwell over this patch of Babur's life have made it highly sympathetic. This is something which even Annette Susannah Beveridge has pointed out. Extreme balance is needed while dealing with especially the first seven years of the non-chronicled period. It is because secondary sources do tell us that Babur was involved in bitter conflicts between the Shi'a and Sunni. So, I am going to attempt to present a brisk summary (in the appendix) of events based on the reading of *Baburnama* translated by Annette Susannah Beveridge. She has used sources which have been not used by William Erskine.

This must be admitted that no other recent contemporary source tells the tale of Babur's life for this period as Babur himself would have narrated. More than anything, the biggest problem that I see for the secondary sources is that almost all of them do not have the central theme of Babur's biography. Among the best-known sources *Ḥabību's-siyar of Khwānd-amīr* and *Tārīkh-i-rashīdī* of *Ḥaidar Mīrzā Dūghlāt*'s top the list. The former was completed nominally